



BRAND GUIDELINES, 2026

CANDID

The visual identity for CANDID, CANDID Solutions, CandidPay, and CandidIQ.

Candid Solutions

CandidPay

CandidIQ

What’s inside

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FOUNDATION

Mission & Vision

Everything in this document protects one thing: the trust CANDID has built with the businesses it serves. Start here before anything else.

MISSION

CANDID exists to simplify and transform business technology and payments, delivering clarity, savings, and operational improvement through tailored solutions in IT, payments, and commerce.

VISION

Short term: empower businesses with innovative payments, IT, and operational solutions that reduce cost and improve day-to-day efficiency.

Long term: become the go-to platform for business technology and payments, built on AI-driven personalization, self-signup, and industry-specific ecosystems.

Brand values

We believe in transparency, innovation, empowerment, reliability, and partnership. These five ideas should show up in every document, call, and pixel CANDID puts into the world.

01

Transparency

We are honest in every deal, every quote, every conversation.

02

Innovation

We use modern technology and AI to simplify what used to be complicated.

03

Empowerment

We help businesses save money and stay in control of their own operations.

04

Reliability

We deliver with accountability, on time and as promised.

05

Partnership

We build long-term relationships focused on our clients' success, not a single sale.

One CANDID, three divisions

CANDID is the parent brand and the name of record. CANDID Solutions, CandidPay, and CandidIQ are the three ways that mission shows up in the world. Each carries its own accent color for quick recognition, but all three share the same logo, type, and voice.



CANDID Solutions

Managed IT, integrations, and business technology, the consulting and implementation arm.



CandidPay

Payment processing and merchant services, the commerce and transactions arm.



CandidIQ

The intelligence platform: commission tracking, reporting, and the CANDID Portal.



Rule of thumb: lead with **CANDID** for anything company-wide (careers, general marketing, the umbrella website). Use the specific sub-brand name only when speaking to that product or service directly.

LOGO

The mark

The CANDID logo pairs a set of seven independent forms with a clean wordmark. The forms represent every business CANDID touches: distinct, individually supported, and moving in the same direction.

Always use an approved logo file. Never rebuild, rotate, stretch, or recolor the mark outside the palette on the following pages.



Variations

Four approved lockups cover nearly every placement. Pick by background, never by preference.



Ink logo

Primary. Use on white or cream backgrounds.



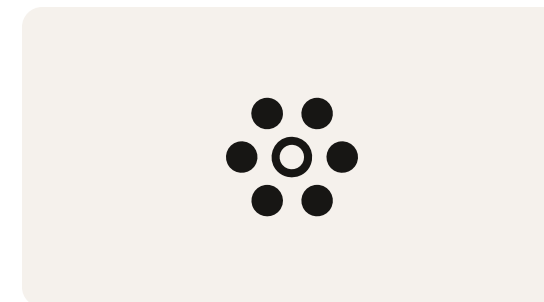
White logo

Use on CANDID Ink, photography, or any dark or busy background.



Accent logo

Secondary. Red for CANDID Solutions, blue for CandidIQ materials.



Mark only

Icon alone, for favicons, app tiles, and social avatars.

Clear space & minimum size

Clear space

Keep an area free of text, graphics, and edges around the logo equal to the height of the icon mark, measured on all four sides. Never let another element crowd the logo.



Minimum size

Below these sizes the wordmark loses legibility. Switch to the icon-only mark instead of shrinking the full lockup further.



Print, 1 in wide minimum



Digital, 24 px icon minimum

Misuse

Four common mistakes to avoid. When in doubt, use an approved file at its original proportions and don't modify it further.



Don't stretch or distort the proportions.



Don't rotate the lockup.



Don't recolor outside the approved palette.



Don't place on low-contrast or busy backgrounds.

Solutions, Pay & IQ

The CANDID wordmark is always set in Neuzeit Grotesk, the typeface built into the logo artwork itself. Solutions uses the plain lockup with no suffix. IQ uses that same Neuzeit Grotesk family for its suffix. Pay is the one exception, set in Helvetica LT Pro Bold Oblique for contrast. Always use the approved files below rather than rebuilding these.



Managed IT & business technology. The main lockup in Crimson, no suffix.



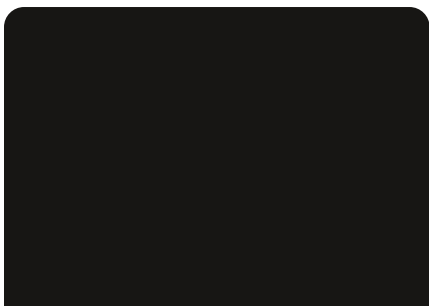
Payments & merchant services. The real CandidPay lockup, "Pay" in Helvetica LT Pro Bold Oblique.



Reporting, analytics & the CANDID Portal. The real CandidIQ lockup, "IQ" in Neuzeit Grotesk.

Primary palette

CANDID Ink and White carry every layout. Blue and Crimson are the two working brand colors, used as accents first, backgrounds second, and always with enough contrast to keep text easy to read.



CANDID Ink

HEX #171614
RGB 23, 22, 20
CMYK 0, 4, 13, 91



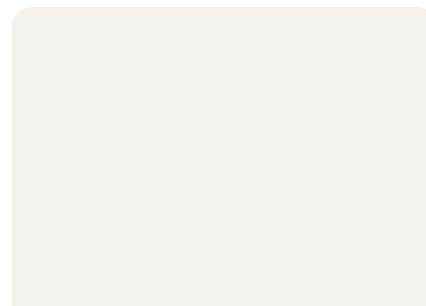
CANDID Blue

HEX #4D6BC1
RGB 77, 107, 193
CMYK 72, 51, 0, 0



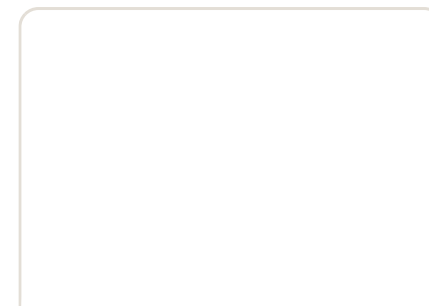
CANDID Crimson

HEX #E91536
RGB 233, 21, 54
CMYK 0, 91, 74, 0



CANDID Cream

HEX #F5F1EC
RGB 245, 241, 236
CMYK 0, 2, 4, 0



White

HEX #FFFFFF
RGB 255, 255, 255
CMYK 0, 0, 0, 0

Sub-brand assignment & tints

Each division owns a color so anyone scanning a page, deck, or dashboard knows which part of CANDID they're looking at before they read a word.

CANDID Solutions
Crimson, #E91536

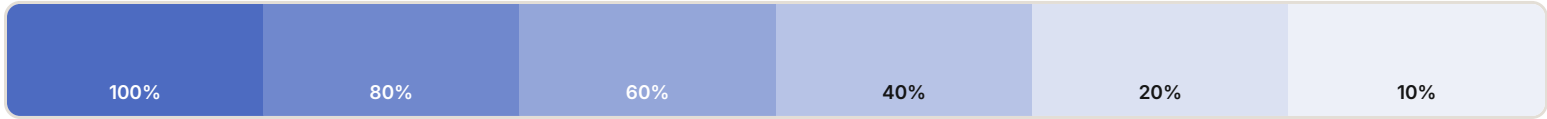
CandidPay
Crimson to Blue gradient

CandidIQ
Blue, #4D6BC1

Crimson tints



Blue tints



Accessibility

Blue and Crimson both pass WCAG AA contrast for large text (18pt+) on white. For body copy under 18pt, set these colors on CANDID Ink or White instead of on each other, and keep white text reserved for the 60% tint and darker.

AA

Pass

TYPOGRAPHY

Logotype fonts

The wordmark itself is not set in a document font. It's built into the logo artwork, drawn in **Neuzeit Grotesk**. Never retype "CANDID" in another typeface; always use the approved logo files.

The "IQ" suffix in the CandidIQ lockup uses that same Neuzeit Grotesk family. The "Pay" suffix in CandidPay is the one deliberate exception, set in **Helvetica LT Pro Bold Oblique** for contrast.

CANDID & IQ, Neuzeit Grotesk



Pay, Helvetica LT Pro Bold Oblique



Document fonts

Archivo is the display face for headlines, eyebrows, and anywhere the brand needs to speak with confidence, in Bold, ExtraBold, and Black.

Aa

Inter is the workhorse for body copy, UI text, captions, and tables.

Aa

System fallback

When Archivo and Inter aren't available, in Word, Outlook, or Excel, use **Arial** for headlines and **Calibri** for body text.

EYEBROW, ARCHIVO EXTRABOLD, TRACKED OUT

Headline, Archivo Black

Subhead, Archivo Bold

Body copy is set in Inter Regular at a comfortable line height. Use **Inter Bold** or italic sparingly, to emphasize a single word or phrase rather than a whole sentence.

Captions, footers, and table data drop to Inter Medium at a smaller size to stay clearly secondary to body copy.

How CANDID looks in the world

Real photography should feel like a working business day: people at counters, dashboards, storefronts, and job sites, not stock-photo handshakes. The four boxes below are temporary placeholders for real photography or approved graphics once they exist.



Icon style

Single-weight line icons at 1.5px stroke, rounded joins, no fill except for status states (success, warning, error) in the semantic colors on the application pages.

Do

Natural light, real environments, one accent color of overlay per image, honest and unposed moments.

Don't

Generic corporate stock photography, heavy filters, clip-art icon packs, or gradients outside the palette.

VOICE

How CANDID sounds

VOICE

Professional, clear, and simple.

TONE

Confident, friendly, and easy to trust.

MESSAGE

Clear tech and payments. Custom solutions that save and grow. Full support from setup to success. Made for businesses, not banks.

Say this

"Your commission report is ready. No spreadsheets required."

Not this

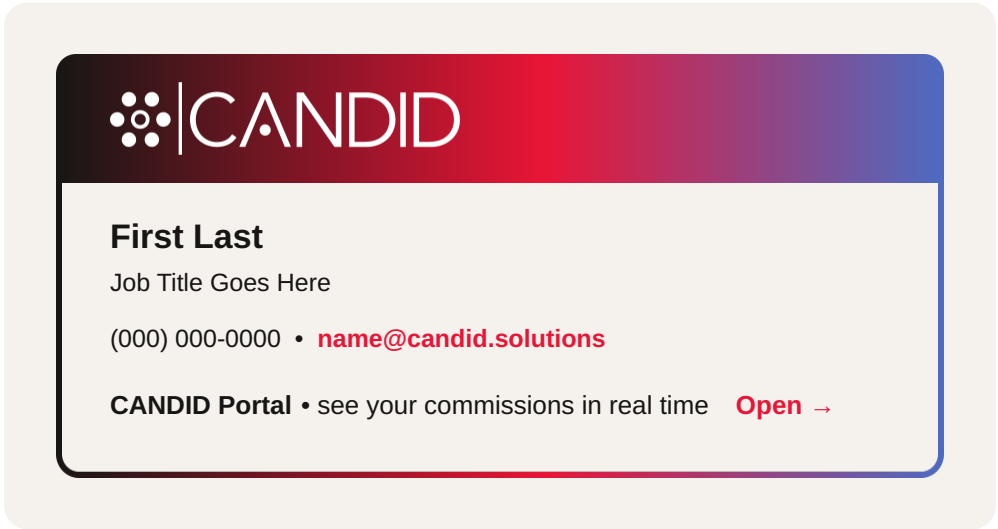
"Leverage our best-in-class, synergistic reporting solution."

Write like you're explaining it to a business owner across the counter: short sentences, plain words, no filler.

Email signature

One template for everyone. Swap the name, title, phone, and email, and change nothing else. The header and border are supplied as image assets so the gradient renders identically in every mail client.

Approved template



Rules

- Use the approved files. Keep the header, border, and spacing as supplied, and leave the body text without a colour so it adapts to the reader's theme.
- No headshots, quotes, social icon rows, or added banners.

Specification

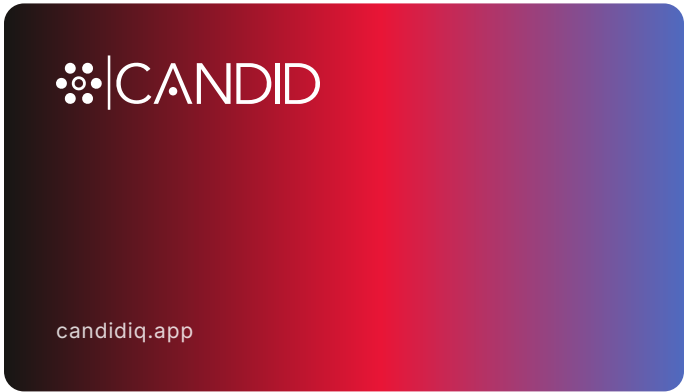
Container width	444 px total, 438 px of content inside a 3 px border.
Border	3 px gradient matching the header bar, equal weight on the left, right, and bottom edges, 10 px rounded corners.
Header	64 px tall, full-width brand gradient with the CANDID mark reversed to white, left-aligned to the content.
Name	Archivo Bold, 17 px.
Title	Inter Regular, 12.5 px.
Contact line	Inter Regular, 12.5 px. Email in Crimson Bold, phone inherits the reader's colour.
Portal line	Inter Regular, 13 px, CTA in Crimson Bold linking to candidiq.app.

Business cards

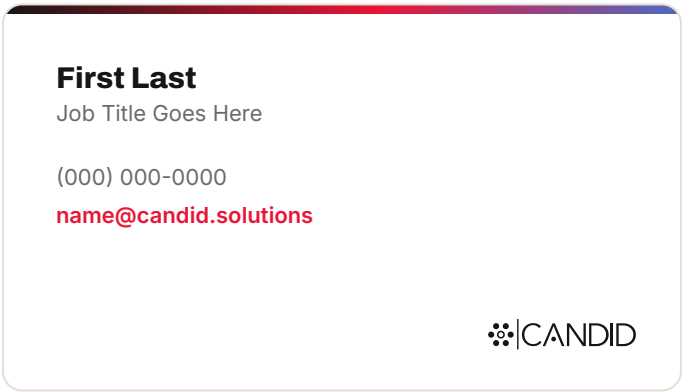
The direction below is settled, the artwork is not. These are indicative mockups showing the intended structure and hierarchy. Final print-ready files will follow.

Direction

In progress



Front



Back

Intended specification

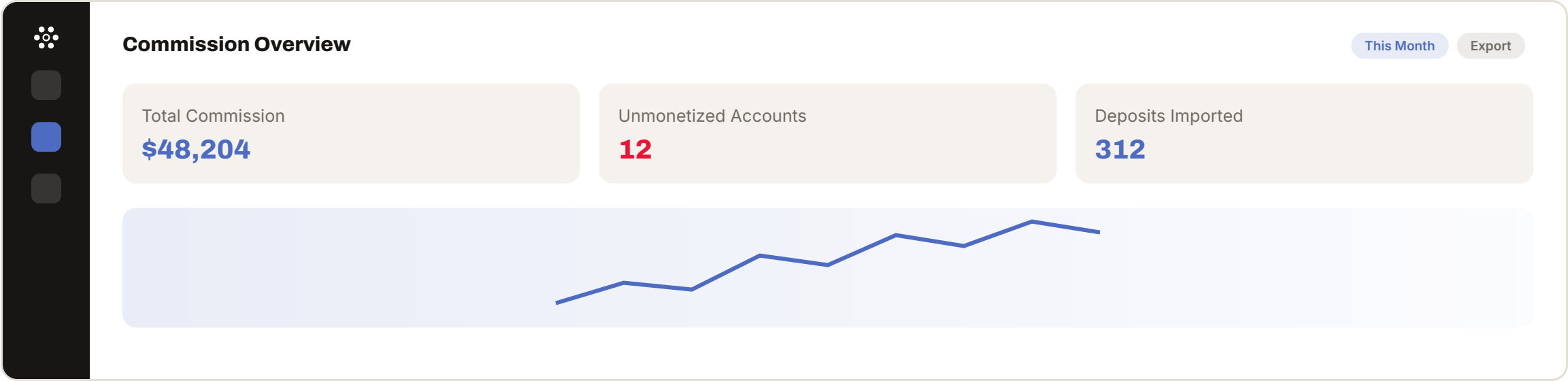
- Format** Double sided. Gradient face on the front, contact details on the back.
- Trim size** 3.5 × 2 in (89 × 51 mm), 3 mm bleed on all edges.
- Stock** 16 pt or heavier, matte or soft-touch finish. No gloss.
- Front** Full-bleed brand gradient with the CANDID mark reversed to white, and candidiq.app set small at the base.
- Back** White face with a gradient rule along the top edge, echoing the email signature. Name in Archivo ExtraBold, rest in Inter.
- Contact** Name, title, phone, and email only. No address, socials, or QR code.

Still to confirm

- Print vendor and stock sample sign-off.
- Whether sub-brand variants are needed for Solutions, Pay, and IQ.
- Don't send anything to print until final files are released.

CandidIQ product UI

CandidIQ’s interface, commission tracking, supplier reporting, deposit imports, and account management, runs on Blue as its primary accent, CANDID Ink navigation, Inter throughout, and Archivo only for numbers and section titles that need to stand out.





**Consistency is the whole point.
When in doubt, keep it simple.**

Questions on usage? Ask before you improvise.